

ARA ROSENTHAL

THE BIG STORY

JUL 22, 2026 6:00 AM

A Teen Reporter Searched for His Community in the Epstein Files. Adults Freaked Out

An Instagram post turned one California student newspaper into a free-speech flash point. The students say they were just doing their homework.



Ben Mueller. PHOTOGRAPH: AMY HARRITY



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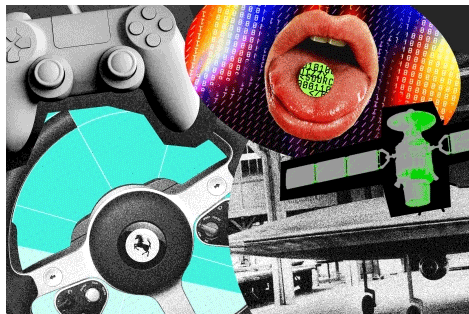
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Kids These Days

- Elite Young Runners Are Becoming Freakishly Fast. [Welcome to ‘Trackflation’](#)
- [Stop Saying](#) Kids Can’t Read
- A Teen Reporter Searched for His Community [in the Epstein Files](#). Adults Freaked Out
- Alpha School’s Ritzy New York City Campus Costs \$65,000 a Year—but [Isn’t Actually a School](#)
- The Truth About [Kids These Days](#)

[Ara Rosenthal](#) is a Bay Area writer pursuing a master’s degree in journalism at UC Berkeley. ...
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ICE Is Using Data Broker Tools to ‘Identify Unaccompanied Minors’ and ‘Fraud’

A newly renewed, \$25 million-per-year contract with a subsidiary of Thomson Reuters further expands the power of ICE under the Trump administration.

CAROLINE HASKINS

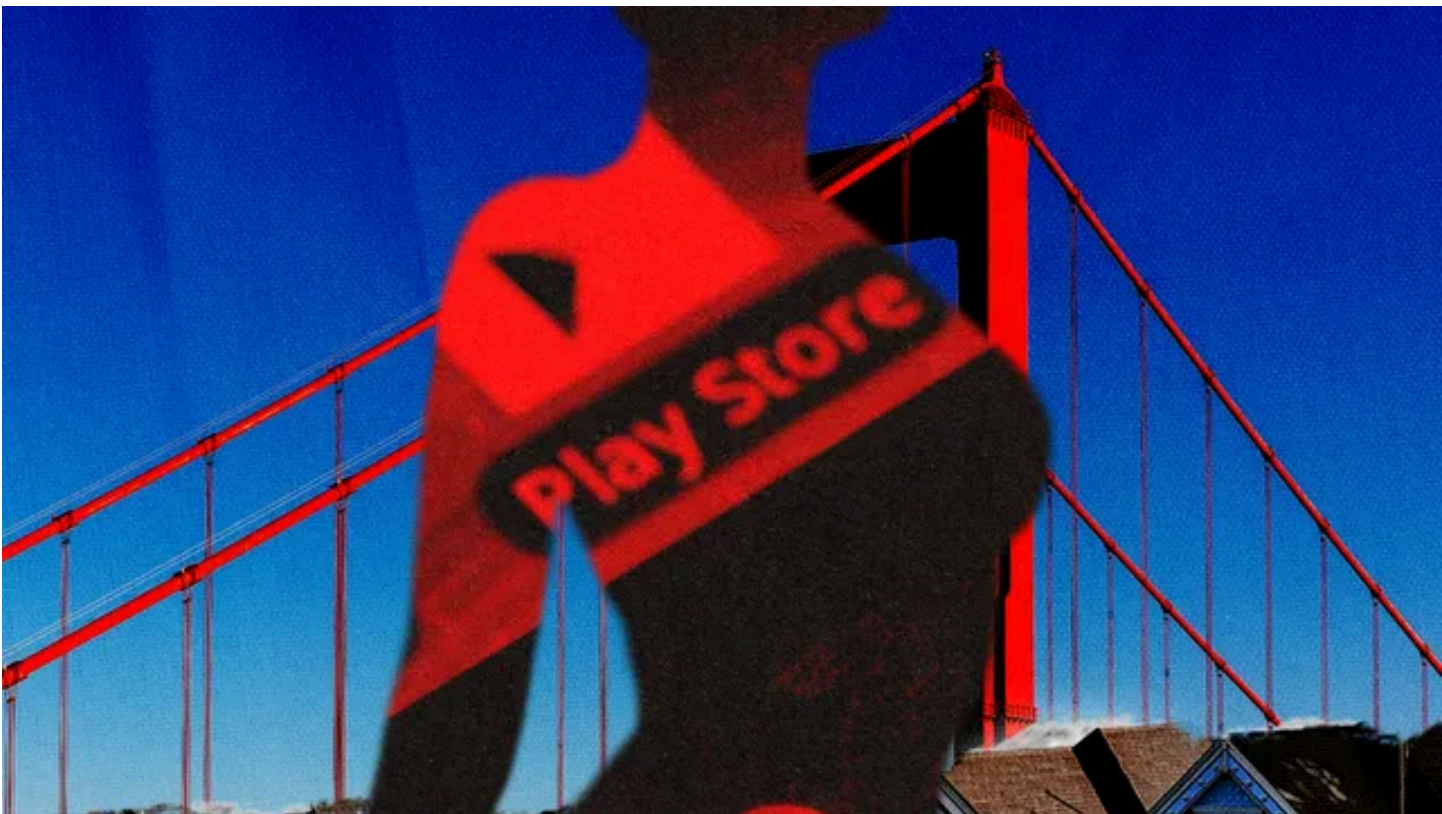
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China-US AI Race Escalates, OpenAI Models Break Free, and Why You Should Check Your Car Alarm

On this episode of *Uncanny Valley*, we dive into accusations that China’s Moonshot AI stole from Anthropic, and how the US Army needs to cut back on AI use.

BRIAN BARRETT



San Francisco Demands Apple and Google Delete AI ‘Nudify’ Apps From App Stores

The City Attorney’s Office sent the tech giants cease-and-desist letters this week telling them to stop profiting from 13 “face-swap” apps that are overwhelmingly used to target women and girls.

MATT BURGESS



European Researchers Say Big Tech Is Blocking Access to Their Data

EU law gives researchers unprecedented rights to scrutinize social media data. Researchers say TikTok, X, and Meta impede their attempts to look inside.

ANNA DESMARAIS



Data Centers Are Quietly Taking Over Texas. The Pollution Could Be Catastrophic

Thousands of new fossil-fuel power sources are quietly firing up across the state to power the AI boom, thanks to a regulatory loophole, leaving residents feeling blindsided.

EVAN SIMON



Cricut Explore 5 vs. Siser Romeo: How Serious Is Your Crafting Habit?

Friendly hobby machine or serious production tool? Here’s how to know which one is for you.

NICOLE KINNING



White Supremacists Love Armie Hammer’s New Movie

Described as the “feel-good movie of white-boy summer” by one extremist, the movie *Citizen Vigilante* has been hailed by the far right as a way to convert moderates to their cause.

DAVID GILBERT



States Want ICE Agents to Show Their Faces. The Trump Administration Is Blocking Them

Federal lawyers say anti-mask laws would endanger immigration agents, citing an ICE face-recognition art project that doesn't actually work.

MADDY VARNER

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